

Batch convert PowerPoint Documents And Templates

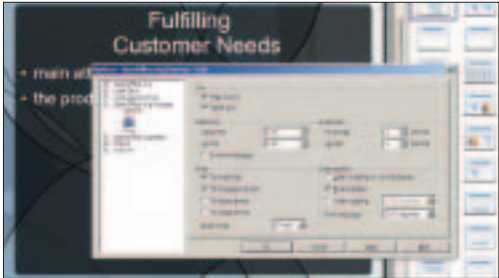
You can batch process MS PowerPoint templates and presentations to be used with OpenOffice.org with the Open Document format. The same procedure can be used with different settings for converting Excel and Word files as well. Go to File > Wizards > Document Converter. The Document Converter window should now open. By default Star Office is selected. Select the Microsoft Office radio button. Check PowerPoint Documents and click on Next. Select the Import from: and Save to: directories for the Templates and the Documents. By default, the PowerPoint templates are in the C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\Templates\Presentation Designs directory. Click on Next. A summary of which directories the templates and documents will be imported from and exported to will show up. Click on Convert and the files will be converted to the Open Document format.

Turn On Reference Options

To turn on the grid in Impress, go to Tools > Options > OpenOffice.org Impress > Grid. Under Grid check Snap to grid and Visible grid. The grid that appears is made up of an array of dots, and not lines. To show Rulers, go to Tools > Options > OpenOffice.org Impress > View. Under Display, check Rulers visible.

Customise The Menu

The top bar can be totally re-ordered and customised according to user preferences. You can rename the menu options of File, Edit, View, Tools etc, add sub-menus and sub-sub menus, re-order the arrangement of the items in each menu and so on. Impress allows total flexibility with regards to the



Turning on the grid

menu. Go to View > Toolbars > Customize. From the Customize window, you can tweak the menus, the keyboard shortcuts, the toolbars and events according to your preferences.

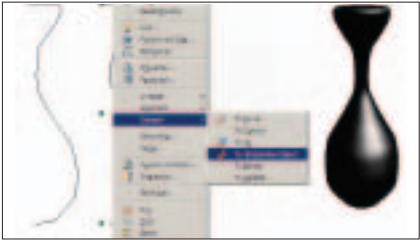
Make 3D Rotation Objects

You can use Impress to create 3D objects from a curve. Although the objects created are not really 3D, they appear to be so. Draw a line or a curve, right-click on it and go to Convert > 3D Rotation Object.

Writer

Creating A New Style

To create a new style, first type in a few text characters anywhere in the document. Apply the font settings that you want, and go to Format > Styles and Formatting or press

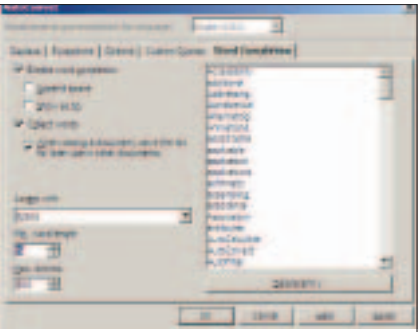


Making 3D rotation objects

[F11]. Click on the New Style from Selection button, and enter the name of the style. You can use the same method to update a particular preset style. To do this, press [F11] then click on the Update Style button.

Auto Completion

Writer can automatically learn and complete long words. This feature is enabled by default, but can be distracting. To disable the feature, go to Tools > AutoCorrect > Word Correction and uncheck Enable word completion. If you want to use this feature, but want to use the space bar to accept a word instead of the [Enter] key. Under the Accept with drop down menu, select Space. If you want to use a particular word, but another word is showing up in the autocomplete feature, press [Ctrl] + [Tab] to cycle forwards through the list or [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Tab] to cycle backwards through the list. To decrease the minimum number of letters for which this feature is active, reduce the min.



The auto completion feature

word length from the default value of 10 to either 5 or 2 as per your choice.

Using The Direct Cursor

The direct cursor feature allows you to start typing anywhere on the page. The feature divides the document into lines and three zones - right, centre and left. Once activated, you can click the cursor anywhere on the page and start typing. To enable the feature, go to Tools > Options > OpenOffice.org Writer > Formatting Aids. Under Direct Cursor, check Direct Cursor. To allow for even more flexibility, and give you the freedom to start writing from

Shortcut Keys Writer

Effect	Shortcut keys
Select All	[Ctrl]+[A]
Justify	[Ctrl]+[J]
Double Underline	[Ctrl]+[D]
Centered	[Ctrl]+[E]
Find and Replace	[Ctrl]+[F]
Superscript	[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[P]
Align Left	[Ctrl]+[L]
Align Right	[Ctrl]+[R]
Subscript	[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[B]
Redo last action	[Ctrl]+[Y]
Apply Default paragraph style	[Ctrl]+[O]
Apply Heading 1 paragraph style	[Ctrl]+[1]
Apply Heading 2 paragraph style	[Ctrl]+[2]
Apply Heading 3 paragraph style	[Ctrl]+[3]
1.5 Line Spacing	[Ctrl]+[5]
Calculates the selected text and copies the result to the clipboard.	[Ctrl]+[+]
Custom hyphens;	
hyphenation set by you.	[Ctrl]+[-]
Non-breaking dash	[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[-]
Run macro field	[Ctrl]+[*]
Non-breaking spaces.	[Ctrl]+[Space]
Line break without paragraph change	[Shift]+[Enter]
Manual page break	[Ctrl]+[Enter]
Column break	[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[Enter]

any point on the page, go to Tools > Options > Open Office.org Writer > Formatting Aids. Under Direct Cursor, select Insert. Finally, select the Tabs and Spaces radio button.

Add Footnotes

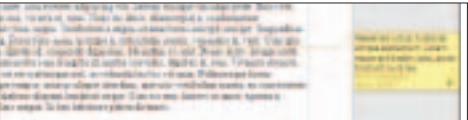
When writing a technical document, it is useful to append footnotes at the end of a page. To add a footnote, bring the cursor to the end of the sentence to which you want to add a footnote, go to Insert > Footnote, and click OK with the default values. The cursor will now be taken to a modified footer, where you can type in the footnote. Footnotes will be added to the end of every page. To collect all the notes at the end of a document, go to Insert > Footnote and under Type select the Endnote radio button.

Use Sections

Sections are a useful feature that allows a part of the document to behave in a different way than the rest of the document. To create a section, go to Insert > Section. The section is by default named serially starting from Section1. Write some text in this section, or copy-paste from another location. To change the way the section behaves, go to Format > Sections. Select a particular section from the list. You can protect a particular section from being changed. Check the Protected check box under Write Protection. You can choose to add a password to this section to remove the write protection. To hide the section in the document, check the Hide checkbox under Hide. To allow only the section to be edited in a write-protected document, check Editable in read-only document under Properties.

Insert Notes

Notes are small post-its like fields for comments or personal reference. Notes can be added anywhere in the document, and show up with a dark yellow line linked to a field to the right of a document. Position the cursor to the left of the character to which you want to add the note to, then go to Insert > Note or use the shortcut [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [N]. If you delete a



Inserting notes

text, the accompanying note will also be deleted. You can edit the note by clicking on it. The note is attached to a particular character on the page, typing before the character will make the note change position too. To keep the notes, but make them invisible, go to View > Notes.

Add Animation To Text

You can add animation to text in drawing objects like circles or rectangles to give more visual appeal to your documents. First, insert an object into the document from the drawing toolbar. If the toolbar is not visible, go to View > Toolbars > Drawing. Once an object is inserted, double-click on it to enter text. After entering the text in the object, select the object and go to Format > Object > Text Attributes > Text Animation. There are four effects available, blink, scroll through, scroll back and forth and scroll in. Most of these effects can be looped infinitely or made to repeat a specific number of times. You can choose other settings like direction, increment and delay. Click on OK when you are done.

IBM Lotus Symphony

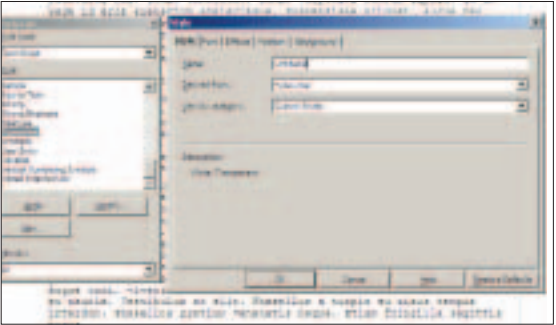
IBM Lotus Symphony is a full featured office suite in one application. The application has word processing, spreadsheet, presentation and web browsing capabilities built in with a tabbed interface. This interface has many benefits. You don't end up cramming up the taskbar if you have many documents open. You can also work on the web (via Internet Explorer), across documents and spreadsheets without even navigating to the taskbar. The menu bar changes to be relevant to each tab that you work upon. The only problem is that Symphony takes up twice as much memory as running MS Excel, MS PowerPoint, MS Word and Internet Explorer all together! However, Lotus Symphony is a free office suite,

and has a familiar look and feel, so it is easy to find your way around.

Documents

Working With The Style Sheet

Formatting text is made easy using the style sheet. The style sheet is a window that pops up with a bunch of preset text formatting options. To apply a format to the text from the style sheet, select the text and press [F11]. A window will pop up with various styles. Go through the Style Type. Drop down menu for access to different styles. To create a custom style, click on



Using the style sheet

the New button, give the style a name, attributes under the Font tab, text effects under the Effects tab and click on OK. Your custom style will be

Shortcut keys For Lotus Symphony Documents

Effect	Shortcut keys
Justify the selection	[Ctrl]+[J]
Apply double	[Ctrl]+[D]
Centre the selection	[Ctrl]+[H]
Italicise the selection	[Ctrl]+[I]
Open the Page Properties window	[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[P]
Left-align the selection	[Ctrl]+[L]
Turn nonprinting characters on or off	[Ctrl]+[M]
Create a new document	[Ctrl]+[N]
Open the Print window	[Ctrl]+[P]
Right-align the selection	[Ctrl]+[R]
Apply subscript to selection	[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[B]
Underline the selection	[Ctrl]+[U]
Close the document	[Ctrl]+[W]
Apply single line spacing to the selection	[Ctrl]+[1]
Apply double line spacing to the selection	[Ctrl]+[2]
Apply single-and-a-half line spacing to the selection	[Ctrl]+[5]
Non-breaking dash	[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[-]
Insert a blank line	[Shift]+[Enter]
Manual page break	[Ctrl]+[Enter]